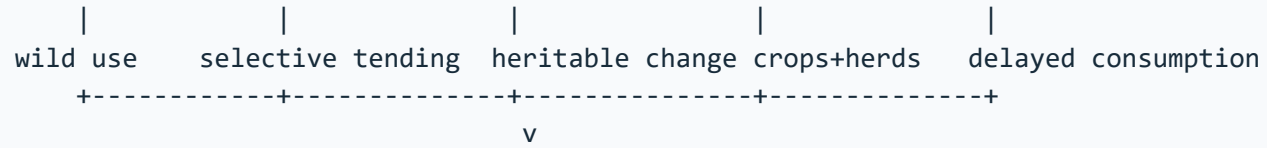


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Food production: a regional mosaic

FORAGING -> MANAGEMENT -> DOMESTICATION -> MIXED FARMING -> SURPLUS/STORAGE



No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.
Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Domestication evidence and causal debate

PLANTS: seed-size/rachis change + weed ecology + storage + grinding tools

ANIMALS: morphology + age/sex kill profile + corrals/dung + herd demography

CAUSES: climate | population | risk buffering | social competition | niche construction

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VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.

Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Technology-settlement-social consequence chain

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery

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cultivation/herding -> houses -> storage -> longer residence -> accumulated property

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+-----+-----+

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craft/exchange growth

disease, labour load and dietary risk

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household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Indian Neolithic regional map

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh -> long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral -> pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa -> rice/date cautions

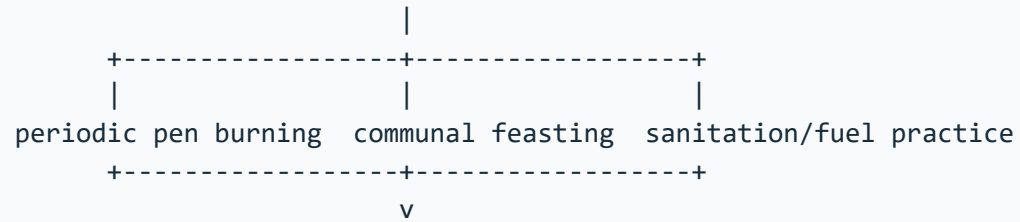
NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

SOUTH: Utnur, Piklihal, Tekkalakota, Hallur -> cattle, millets, ash mounds

RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Ash mounds: formation-function debate

BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT -> SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND

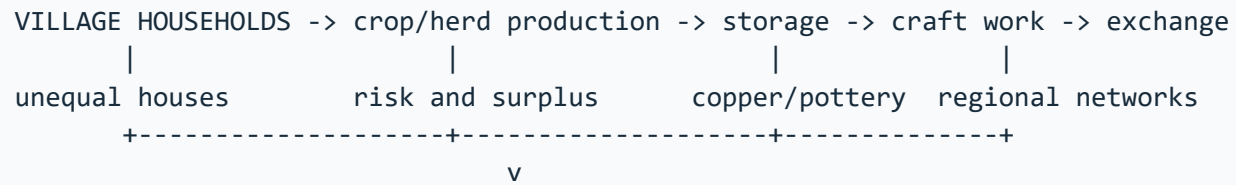


Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.
Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Chalcolithic cultures: region-site-marker matrix

CULTURE/ZONE	CORE SITES	HIGH-YIELD MARKERS
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura	Ganeshwar/Jodhpura	copper craft; Harappan contact
Ahar-Banas	Ahar, Balathal, Gilund	black-red ware; copper; farming
Kayatha	Kayatha	early Malwa sequence; rich deposits
Malwa	Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda	painted ware; large villages; spread
Jorwe	Inamgaon, Nevasa	Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe
OCP/Copper Hoards	upper Ganga sites	association varies; no ethnic label

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Chalcolithic rural political economy



Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Decline, transformation and cultural labels

LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation

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some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies + local continuity

CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.

CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation.

CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Neolithic-Chalcolithic answer architecture

10 MARKS: define phase -> process -> two regional sites -> evidence caution

15 MARKS: transition causes -> domestication proof -> technology/settlement -> comparison

20 MARKS: mosaic chronology -> regional map -> Chalcolithic matrix -> economy/society

-> ash-mound debate -> transformation -> qualified synthesis

Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.

CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. Test cultivation, domestication, sedentism, pottery and storage separately.
2. Anchor every culture in region, site, assemblage and dated sequence.
3. Treat adoption, local development, mobility and interaction as testable models.

VERDICT: Neolithisation is a regional mosaic, not one revolution or diffusion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Rice presence is not domestication; a polished celt alone is not farming.
2. Chalcolithic means copper plus stone, not universal metal use or urbanism.
3. OCP, copper hoards and Ganeshwar overlap partly but are not one people.

VERDICT: Culture labels classify assemblages; they do not prove ethnicity or polity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Use 2021 Q37 to separate Burzahom pits, Chandraketugarh art and Ganeshwar copper.
2. Compare north-west, Kashmir, Ganga/east, north-east and southern pathways.
3. Write claim -> site/culture -> evidence -> inference -> chronology limit.

VERDICT: Rural food-producing cultures overlapped, interacted and changed unevenly.